

SEID 2364 – Final Assignment

Ethical Position Statements Portfolio

Section 2 – Personal Ethical Position Statement

A. Personal Ethical Position Statement

I believe that long term well-being of human beings is a primary good that I pursue in my ethical system, with a caveat of raising minimal available level of well being or *lifestyle takes precedence to a degree. Human freedom I would define as the second most important priority. I attempt to build my decisions on a basis of approaching objectivity as close as possible, partially on a basis of dialectical materialism(1) and consequentialism(2) and Hedonism(3), as affecting our surroundings and material conditions in my personal point of view is the best pathway to collective happiness. 1) In this vein personal responsibility of every societal participant is to pursue both personal happiness and well being of people in their proximity to a degree which doesn't meaningfully harm themselves. Uncrossable ethical boundaries in this system are - (1) Infinite value of human life. 2) Personal freedoms may not impose on personal freedoms of others, although collective freedom can. 3) Long term good and longevity of humanity as a collective is of absolute importance. 4) Critical thought towards the

system requires some interpretation within parameters. 5)
Eliminating bias to the utmost degree.

B. Analysis and Influences

My personal ideology is based on personal ethical sense formed through reading and analysing different ideologies as well as seeing and analysing real ethical cases. Because my personal feeling of empathy is very acute I try to operate in the day to day as to create as much good for the people around me. However I understand that martyrdom is seldom optimal as usually it becomes a tragic historical footnote(4). Therefore rational personal sacrifice is such that does not impede the individual in an ultimate way is also a part of this ideology. Within this framework the ethical system most closely aligns with consequentialism, dialectical materialism and modern idea of Hedonism. I am personally extremely sensitive to personal bias and contemplating this topic during the course made me very attuned to sensing it in my own conceptions.

Section 3 – Professional Ethical Position Statement

A/B Professional Ethical Position Statement/Analysis: Professional Standards and Influences

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In a professional way I would use my own system as the baseline of creating it. If we were to position a professionals ethical system

from the point of view of responsibility, we could create a hierarchy of needs that the product created or worked on by a data scientist may have.

In this case a hierarchy of needs and responsibilities of a data scientist would be as such (1 -most important)

1) Society

Responsibility to maintain integrity and well being of a societal structure. Local to global transition with least possible ethical dilemmas between (for example if a data centre unethically uses resources of a neighbour country to provide a service to the local population, its value should be heavily re/considered.) Here the most important values to consider are transparency and fairness.

Analysis

This part of the system aligns with the ACM Code of Ethics, particularly Principle 1.1, "Contribute to society and to human well-being," and Principle 1.2, "Avoid harm." Similarly, the IEEE Code of Ethics requires professionals to hold paramount the safety, health, and welfare of the public.

2) Users

Responsibility to do no harm to the users of the platform to a reasonable degree (absence of predatory algorithms, manipulation techniques and so on...)

For Users privacy would take the centre stage of values, if it would not meaningfully impede pursuit of transparency and fairness of the societal benefits.

Analysis

This perspective aligns with ACM principles concerning privacy, confidentiality, and avoiding harm, as well as IEEE commitments to fairness, respect for human rights, and responsible disclosure of risks. It also reflects modern organisational standards surrounding data protection and ethical AI governance .

3) Organisation

The organisations longevity is the largest responsibility towards it from a position of an employed data engineer. Provided the responsibilities before are fulfilled the existence of the organisation would be considered a good from the point of view of this system. Efficiency would be the main considered factor here, as economical sustainability is the goal of this

Analysis

The ACM Code recognises professional competence and quality of work as ethical responsibilities, and many organisational policies emphasise efficiency, reliability, and responsible resource management.

Potential tensions emerge when organisational objectives conflict with societal or user welfare. For example, an organisation may benefit financially from extensive behavioural tracking or engagement-maximising algorithms that exploit users' vulnerabilities. My hierarchy deliberately rejects the idea that profitability alone can justify such practices.

4) Stakeholders

Provided the previous responsibilities are fulfilled the stakeholders within the organisation will have their needs fulfilled by default, as benefits to society and organisation will inevitably result to an ethically structured benefit for them as well. (5)

Analysis

This perspective diverges somewhat from traditional business models that prioritise shareholder value maximisation. However, it is increasingly supported by stakeholder theory and contemporary approaches to corporate social responsibility, which argue that long-term stakeholder benefits depend upon maintaining public trust and social legitimacy.

Section 4 – Alignment, Tension, and Governmental Authority

From the point of view of the government regulation this system can be used as a guiding hand of the organisation. But due to malleability of the human governance in an ideal scenario and algorithm could be developed that would with minimal bias analyse the cases. The algorithm would still have human oversight, however it would only be done to ensure the algorithm itself works as intended with no statistical anomalies. In the ideal scenario it would also be expanded to a new version of a document similar to EU AI Act that would be the dictating force within the industry.

Section 5 – Position Resilience and Future Capabilities

A. Future Scenario

In the near future, governments and healthcare providers deploy highly advanced AI systems capable of integrating medical records, genomic data, behavioural data from wearable devices, purchasing histories, and social determinants of health. These systems predict individual risks of severe diseases with high accuracy and automatically allocate preventative interventions and healthcare resources. As in my previous reports in the extreme case it could even decide life and death in case of euthanasia.

B. Stress Test of Your Positions

This professional system would improve health outcomes of the society as it would prioritise transparency and good of the majority over capital gain of the stakeholders. Unbiased algorithmic justice

will result in an improvement in outcomes as it would functionally make corruption impossible.

My personal system would ensure a Hypocratic-esque do no harm policy of the data scientist. As the scientist themselves will be concerned with the benefit of the society and broader global well-being and longevity they would become a working cog in the system that would benefit everyone (in an ideal scenario)

C. Adaptation and Revision

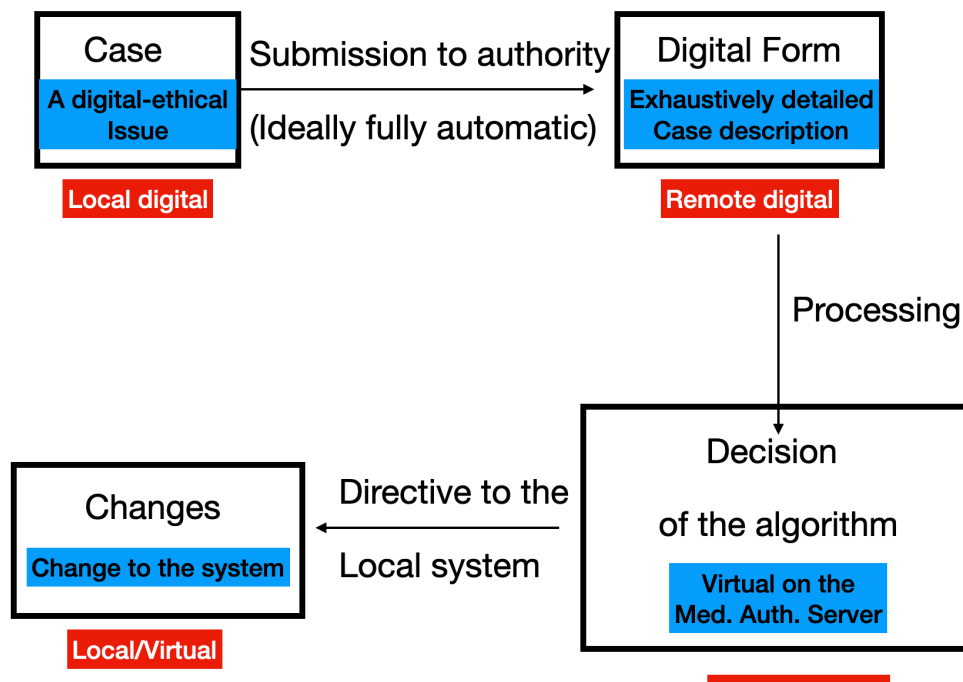
My assumptions depend on the fact that we do not fully understand human psychology, however through the lens of dialectical materialism we assume some level of determinism in human intelligent behaviour. By using this system we can improve material conditions and therefore improve outcomes to societies. Large problem with an algorithmic ethical system is its lack of adaptability as well as absence of a clear path to its improvement, due to the black box nature of the algorithm.

Section 6 – AI Use Statement

- I used GPT 5.5 to create an imaginary scenario to try to eliminate bias from the example.

Mediation Pathway (BBS) Requirement

Within the system a signal which would be an ethical case to analyse with a direct pathway from conception to decision.



Caption

References and Sources

- 1) McFarland, R. B., Spitaler, G., & Zechner, I. (2020). *The Red Vienna Sourcebook*. Boydell & Brewer.
- 2) Driver, J. (2011). *Consequentialism*. Routledge.
- 3) SANDUA, D. (2024). THE MODERN HEDONIST: STRATEGIES FOR LIVING FULLY. David Sandua.
- 4) Poulson, M. G., Erp, S. van, & Boeve, L. (2017). *Grace, Governance and Globalization*. Bloomsbury Publishing.
- 5) Harris, J. D., & Wicks, A. C. (2014). Public Trust and Trust in Particular Firm–Stakeholder Interactions: A Theoretical Model and Implications for Management.